Choice and flexibility in assessment

Can students make meaningful choices in assessment?

ACCESSIBILITY / ASSESSMENT

ONE-PAGE TEACHING GUIDE

WHAT IS IT?

Genuine choice of topic is available where not itself the outcome; format variety spans items, not one task

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

Accessibility is about usability, not just technical availability. A resource, room or activity can exist while still costing some students far more energy to perceive, navigate, understand or act on. Repeated friction sends a message about who the default user is.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “The information exists, but finding and using it takes more effort than learning it.”
- “I have to keep asking for a version I can actually use.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Offer choice where it supports engagement and does not compromise outcomes.
- Distribute format variety across the course rather than making one “special” flexible task.
- Keep guidance clear so choice reduces barriers rather than creating confusion.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

Across a semester, students complete a mix of written, oral and practical tasks and can choose the topic focus for one major assignment.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

For this assessment, we aim to offer meaningful choice in how students demonstrate the same learning outcomes where the task allows it. The learning outcomes being assessed are [insert outcomes].

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